As much as I enjoy my engineering curriculum, it could never hope to cover all aspects of problem solving or general lessons that I need to learn. At Iowa State, I have only taken two general education classes: HIST 2010, Intro to Western Civilization, and ARCH 3210, History of the American City. Going back to high school, I gained equivalent experience to ECON 101, Principles of Microeconomics, and SPAN 2010, Intermediate Spanish I. These courses helped me gain a better understanding of real-world problem solving.

Starting in high school, I built a foundation with college-level classes. I excelled in Microeconomics, learning about basic principles of supply and demand, cost tradeoffs, et cetera. These concepts have applied directly to my senior design project, where I have had to consider more than just the technical implementations I learned in my engineering curriculum to develop a solution that is cost-effective, widely available, and otherwise consumer-friendly. I also took intermediate-level Spanish courses, where I not only learned the principles of the language, but also dove into the culture of Spanish-speaking countries across the globe. Speaking in a new language is a great way to grasp the basic concepts of communication that I wouldn't have thought of when speaking my native language, and has helped me communicate with a wide variety of peers and team members.

Here at Iowa State, I took Intro to Western Civilization in my first semester. Through endless battles, invasions, ages, empires, monarchs, and emperors, what stuck with me was the constant innovation of society. Through periods of flourishing arts and science and periods of tyrannical reign and despair, humanity adapted and persisted. I try to carry this innovative spirit into my engineering experiences by expanding my learning as much as possible by working on personal projects and joining new clubs like ChipForge. Following that, I took History of the American City. I learned about how the decisions of city planners, landlords, and politicians served or attacked different populations through environmental and architectural factors. Now, I strive to serve as many people as possible through making my engineering solutions widely available, such as the fully open-source stack in my senior design project.

Economic barriers, market concentration, and excluded populations are significant problems in society. With my perspectives gained from my general education classes, I am better equipped to tackle these issues by ensuring what I contribute is accessible, responsible, and innovative. I work daily to consider every angle of engineering issues and make sure my technical ambition doesn't outweigh my dedication to impactful engineering solutions.